

Loyalty Signaling in Hong Kong (1997–2026)

Textual Analysis of Political Discourse — Deng, X., Liu, J., & Zhong, J. (HKU)

⚙️ Enhanced TF-IDF Logic

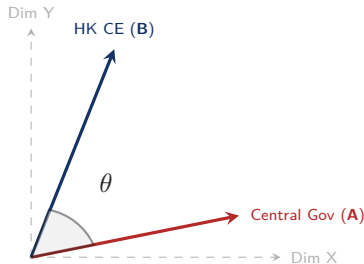
1. Feature Boosting (Manual Weighting):

- Identifies `loyalty_signaling_keywords` in raw text.
- **Triples frequency** (adds 2 clones per hit) to ensure loyalty signals dominate the vector.

2. Domain-Specific Noise Filtering:

- **Max DF (0.85)**: Strips extremely common tokens that appear in more than 85% of the texts.
- **Min DF (2)**: Removes words that appear fewer than two times in the entire corpus
- **Custom Stopwords**: Removes 40+ neutral tokens like *pandemic*, *transport*, *quarantine*.
- **Jieba Tokenization**: Handles complex compound phrases in Simplified/Traditional Chinese.

📈 Cosine Similarity Metric



Rationale: Measures **thematic orientation** rather than length. A score of 1.0 indicates identical keyword distribution, while a score of 0 means the two set of words are completely dissimilar.